CMCC Duties and Responsibilities for SIPR Assets

Custody, Couriering, Imaging, and Return Procedures

Audience: Marines and staff who may receive, move, image, store, or return classified SIPR assets.

Training outcome: understand the vocabulary, records, custody standards, courier requirements, and end-to-end process for temporary unit-to-unit transfer of SIPR assets.

Outline

This deck moves in seven parts, from vocabulary to a full imaging workflow:

1. **Foundations and Vocabulary** — the terms and control systems behind classified SIPR handling.
2. **Authorization, Custody, and Records** — who may sign, how to validate them, and what records prove custody.
3. **Moving Classified Assets** — courier, packaging, transport, and acceptance requirements.
4. **Inventory and Accountability** — keeping both units' records true.
5. **The 3NB Imaging Workflow** — the end-to-end scenario, from customer prep to return.
6. **Severity, Checklists, and Everyday Rules** — consequences and quick-reference practice.
7. **Special Handling and the Bottom Line** — upclassing, working notes, and stop-the-line judgment.

Foundations and Vocabulary

1. Scope and Ground Rules

This deck provides a **policy-level SOP model** for SIPR laptops, hard drives, removable media, and related classified/COMSEC material.

It does **not** replace:

- Local Command Security Manager direction.
- COMSEC Manager/KMI Operating Account guidance.
- Sensitive Compartmented Information (SCI) and Special Access Program (SAP)-specific rules.
- Local vault/open-storage approval documentation.

When local policy is stricter than this deck, use the stricter rule.[1]

COUNTER EXAMPLE: treating local procedures as optional can turn a minor administrative mistake into an accountability failure.

2. Classified Information vs. Classified Material

Classified information is national-security information marked Confidential, Secret, or Top Secret.

Classified material is the physical or digital object that contains, stores, records, or embeds classified information.

Examples:

- SIPR laptop.
- Classified hard drive or solid-state drive.
- Removable media.
- Printed document.
- COMSEC keying material or equipment.

COUNTER EXAMPLE: if a laptop chassis is tracked but the classified drive is not, the command may lose accountability for the actual classified material.

3. What Is a CMCC?

A **Classified Material Control Center (CMCC)** is a local command control function for receiving, logging, storing, issuing, inventorying, and returning classified material.
A **secondary control point** is a subordinate custody point—such as a section, lab, vault, or room custodian—that controls classified material locally while remaining accountable to the primary CMCC/security program.

Plain meaning: the CMCC is the place or function that answers, “Who has this classified item, where is it, and what record proves it?”

COUNTER EXAMPLE: without a CMCC-style control point, classified assets can move by habit, email, or word of mouth instead of by accountable custody.

4. What Is COMSEC?

Communications Security (COMSEC) protects communications from exploitation and ensures authenticity.

COMSEC includes:

- Cryptographic security.
- Transmission security.
- Emissions security.
- Physical security of COMSEC material and information.[3]

COMSEC material includes items designed to secure or authenticate telecommunications, including key, equipment, modules, devices, documents, hardware, firmware, or software that embody cryptographic logic or perform COMSEC functions.[4]

DEVIATION CONSEQUENCE: mishandling COMSEC material may be more serious than ordinary property loss because it can affect cryptographic trust and mission communications.

5. What Are CMCS, EKMS, KMI, and KOA?

The **COMSEC Material Control System (CMCS)** is the logistics and accounting system used to distribute, control, and safeguard COMSEC material marked **"CRYPTO"**.[5]

Here, **"CRYPTO"** is a COMSEC marking/control label—not another acronym to decode.

Electronic Key Management System (EKMS) and **Key Management Infrastructure (KMI)** are examples of tools used by CMCS; KMI provides generation, production, storage, protection, distribution, control, tracking, and destruction for cryptographic keying material.[5][6]

A **KMI Operating Account (KOA)** is the KMI account relationship used to manage devices and control distribution of KMI products to those devices.[7]

COUNTER EXAMPLE: using a property receipt, like a consolidated memorandum receipt (CMR), alone for COMSEC/KMI material may fail to meet COMSEC accountability requirements.

6. What Is CCI?

A **Controlled Cryptographic Item (CCI)** is normally unclassified equipment or a cryptographic component handled through the COMSEC Material Control System, an equivalent control system, or both.[8]

Important distinction: CCI may be unclassified by itself, but it is still controlled.

Examples may include approved cryptographic devices, components, or modules that perform a COMSEC function.

COUNTER EXAMPLE: treating CCI as ordinary IT gear can create a COMSEC incident even when the item is not marked classified.

7. What Are SF-153, SD-572, and CBAF?

SF-153 is the COMSEC Material Report. It may support transfer, inventory, destruction, hand-receipt, or other COMSEC material reporting actions.[9]

SD-572 is the Cryptographic Access Certification and Termination form used to certify and terminate access to U.S. classified cryptographic information.[10]

CBAF: for this deck, CBAF refers to the local **Command Billet Access Form** or equivalent billet/access validation artifact. Treat it as a local command record that may support access validation, not as a substitute for clearance, need-to-know, courier appointment, SD-572, SF-153, or CMCC custody records unless local policy explicitly says otherwise.

COUNTER EXAMPLE: using the wrong validation document may mean the recipient was never properly authorized to receive or access the material.

Authorization, Custody, and Records

8. Policy Baseline

Classified material must be protected by one of two conditions:[11]

1. Stored as required by policy.
2. Under the personal observation and control of an authorized person.[11]

Before access is granted, the person must have:[12]

- Proper clearance eligibility.
- SF-312 on file.
- Need-to-know.
- Any additional COMSEC, cryptographic, NATO, SCI, SAP, or local briefing required for the material.[12]

COUNTER EXAMPLE: custody without authorization is not just poor paperwork; it can be unauthorized disclosure.

9. Who May Sign for Classified SIPR Assets?

Qualified signers should be appointed or otherwise documented by the command before accepting custody.[12]

Typical qualified signers include:

- Command Security Manager or alternate.
- CMCC custodian or alternate.
- COMSEC Manager, KOA Manager, or alternate, when COMSEC/KMI material is involved.
- Formally appointed hand-receipt holder or lab custodian.

Do **not** let an ordinary end user sign merely because they are the technical point of contact.[12]

DEVIATION CONSEQUENCE: release to an unqualified signer is at least an accountability failure and may become a compromise if access was not authorized.

10. How to Validate a Recipient Before Release

Before releasing the asset, validate:

1. Identity: CAC/DoD ID and unit affiliation.
2. Eligibility: clearance level and access record.
3. Need-to-know: mission requirement for that asset.
4. Appointment: courier letter/card, access roster, CMCC appointment, COMSEC appointment, or lab-custodian designation.
5. Special access: SD-572 or local COMSEC/KMI validation when classified cryptographic information is involved.[13]

For classified cryptographic information, SD-572 Section I must be executed before access, and Section II must be executed when access is no longer required.[14]

COUNTER EXAMPLE: if qualification is assumed instead of validated, the release may become a security violation or compromise.

11. Core Custody Records

Use the record required by the material type.[9][10][22]

Material type	Minimum record
Ordinary classified SIPR asset	CMCC log and local hand receipt
Classified hard drive/media	CMCC/media log and hand receipt
COMSEC material	SF-153 or COMSEC-account-directed record
Classified cryptographic information access	SD-572 and access briefing/debriefing record
Property accountability	Property record, GCSS-MC/DPAS/local equivalent

The custody record should identify the item without adding unnecessary classified operational detail.[15]

COUNTER EXAMPLE: a property record may prove ownership, but it does not automatically prove classified custody.[22]

12. Temporary Hand Receipts

A temporary hand receipt should record:

- Releasing unit and accepting unit.
- Releasing official, receiving official, and witness when required.
- Courier name and courier authorization reference.
- Chassis serial number and property tag.
- Hard-drive or storage-media serial numbers.
- Classification level and control caveats.
- Exact purpose, date/time, expected return, and temporary storage location.

Material removed from an approved open-storage area must be controlled and accounted for until returned.[15]

COUNTER EXAMPLE: incomplete hand receipts make it difficult to determine last known location, responsible person, and whether a loss occurred.

13. Serial Number Validation

Validate both:

1. **Chassis serial/property tag** for the laptop or workstation.
2. **Drive/media serials** for internal drives, removable drives, SSDs, and other classified storage media. **Best practice:** record drive serials at release, intake, before imaging, after imaging, before return, and at final receipt.

DEVIATION CONSEQUENCE: a missing or swapped hard drive is potentially a loss of classified material, even if the laptop chassis is present.

Moving Classified Assets

14. Courier Requirements

For this SOP, a courier package should include:

- Courier appointment letter.
- Issued courier card or DD Form 2501 if used locally.
- DoD ID and government photo ID.
- Copy of inventory or hand receipt retained by courier.
- Office-retained copy of inventory or hand receipt.
- Locked, opaque, durable container such as an approved Pelican-style case.
- Inner sealed package or administrative packet as locally required.

DEVIATION CONSEQUENCE: couriering without documented authorization is an infraction at minimum; loss of custody can become a violation or compromise.

15. Packaging and Pelican Case Standards

For hand-carry outside an activity, a locked briefcase or zippered pouch may serve as the outer wrapper; a locally approved locked Pelican-style case can serve the same practical purpose if approved by the Security Manager and compatible with local policy.[19]

Do not mark the outside of the container in a way that reveals or advertises classified contents.[20]

COUNTER EXAMPLE: poor packaging can create accidental exposure, tampering uncertainty, or unauthorized disclosure.

16. Government Vehicle vs. POV

Preferred method: government vehicle with official routing and direct travel.

POV use: only when authorized by the command or Security Manager and when the courier can maintain continuous personal custody.[21]

Courier rules apply regardless of vehicle:

- Do not leave the material unattended.
- Do not make unauthorized stops.
- Do not open the package en route except under policy-defined circumstances.
- Arrange approved secure storage if travel is interrupted or overnight storage becomes necessary.[21]

DEVIATION CONSEQUENCE: leaving classified material in a POV, even briefly, may be a reportable security violation and may become a loss or compromise.

17. Acceptance at the Receiving Unit

The receiving unit should sign only after completing a physical sighting and record check.[15]

Acceptance should include:

1. Validate courier identity and courier authority.
2. Compare hand receipt/SF-153 to the physical asset.
3. Verify chassis serial and drive/media serials.
4. Inspect seals, locks, and packaging for tampering.
5. Record date/time, location, receiving official, and witness if required.
6. Refuse or annotate discrepancies before signing.

DEVIATION CONSEQUENCE: signing before verification creates false custody and may conceal loss, tampering, or unauthorized substitution.

Inventory and Accountability

18. How the Hand Receipt Enters Inventory

The owning unit should annotate its inventory when classified material leaves approved open storage or changes temporary custody.[22]

> "Issued on temporary hand receipt to [unit] for [purpose], [date/time], expected return [date/time]."

The receiving unit should enter the asset into a temporary custody log with:[22]

- Owning unit.
- Receiving custodian.
- Room or container location.
- Authorized movement locations.
- Work status.
- Return status.

COUNTER EXAMPLE: if neither unit inventory reflects temporary custody, the asset is effectively uncontrolled.

19. Monthly and Event-Driven Inventory

For this battalion, treat **100% CMCC inventory** as the normal monthly accountability standard, not an exceptional event.

Also conduct a **100% inventory** when any of these triggers occur under the local battalion order:

- 20% or more of the inventory changes.
- Primary or alternate custodians turn over.
- A security incident, discrepancy, suspected compromise, or loss concern occurs.
- Temporary customer assets are received, imaged, transferred, or returned.

DEVIATION CONSEQUENCE: delayed inventory can delay discovery of loss and increase damage assessment scope.

The 3NB Imaging Workflow

20. Scenario: Customer Unit Prepares Asset for 3NB Imaging

For this deck, **3NB** refers to the receiving/imaging unit or CMCC function performing the SIPR imaging work.

The customer unit should:

1. Contact its Security Manager, CMCC, vault custodian, or COMSEC Manager as applicable.
2. Retrieve the SIPR asset from approved storage.
3. Validate chassis and drive/media serials.
4. Prepare the hand receipt, SF-153 if COMSEC material is involved, and courier packet.
5. Appoint or validate the courier.
6. Package the asset in the approved locked case.
7. Retain a complete copy of the transfer packet.

The asset should not be released directly from an end user or help desk without CMCC/security accountability.[2][12]

COUNTER EXAMPLE: bypassing CMCC creates a custody gap before the asset ever reaches 3NB.

21. Scenario: 3NB Receives the Asset

At 3NB, the asset should be received by one of the following documented/authorized custodians:[12]

- 3NB CMCC custodian or alternate.
- Command Security Manager or alternate.
- COMSEC/KOA Manager or alternate when COMSEC/KMI applies.
- Formally appointed SIPR imaging lab custodian.

The 3NB receiver should:[15]

1. Verify courier authority.
2. Inspect package condition.
3. Validate all recorded serial numbers.
4. Sign receipt only after physical validation.
5. Enter the item into the 3NB temporary classified-material custody log.
6. Store the complete packet with the CMCC record, not just in the technician's notes.

COUNTER EXAMPLE: if a technician signs without appointment, the record may not establish valid transfer of custody.

22. Scenario: Imaging Lab Storage

A SIPR imaging lab may store assets only if the room is approved for the classification level and storage method.[25]

If the room is **not** approved open storage, assets should be stored in a GSA-approved container, vault, or other approved storage when not under direct observation and control of an authorized person.[25]

COUNTER EXAMPLE: an electronically controlled room that is not approved storage can still be improper classified storage.

23. Scenario: Recording Location Inside 3NB

The customer-to-3NB hand receipt should identify the receiving unit and authorized purpose.[15]

The 3NB internal custody log should record the most precise controlled location practical, such as:[22]

- Building.
- Room number.
- Vault/container number.
- Imaging bench or cage identifier if locally used.
- Date/time of internal movement.
- Person moving the asset and witness if required.

Recommended wording: the customer receipt may state “3NB CMCC/SIPR imaging lab, approved storage locations only,” while the 3NB custody log records exact room/container movement.

COUNTER EXAMPLE: building-only tracking may be insufficient if the asset cannot be immediately located during inventory.

24. Scenario: Moving Customer Assets Between Rooms

Moving a customer asset between rooms should preserve accountability and approved storage; require: [15][25]

1. Authorized person moving the asset.
2. Continuous custody or proper packaging.
3. Update to internal custody log.
4. Witness or two-person integrity (TPI) when required by material type or local SOP.
5. Storage only in approved rooms or containers.

A new customer hand receipt is not required for every internal room move if 3NB remains the accountable temporary custodian and the internal movement log is complete.[22]

COUNTER EXAMPLE: unlogged internal movement can look identical to loss during an audit.

25. Scenario: Imaging Complete and Customer Notification

When imaging is complete, 3NB should close out custody before release:[15]

1. Reconcile chassis and drive/media serials.
2. Verify no extra classified media, labels, notes, or removable devices remain with the asset.
3. Close out lab work notes without adding unnecessary classified details.
4. Notify the customer unit's CMCC, Security Manager, vault custodian, or COMSEC Manager—not merely the end user.
5. Require the customer to send an appointed courier with courier authorization.

COUNTER EXAMPLE: notifying only the end user can result in release to a person who lacks authority to accept custody.

26. Scenario: Return to Customer Unit

Return should mirror intake so custody remains documented through final receipt:[15]

1. Customer courier arrives with valid authorization.
2. 3NB validates courier identity and authority.
3. 3NB and courier physically sight the asset.
4. Both parties validate chassis and drive/media serials.
5. 3NB signs release and closes temporary custody log.
6. Customer signs acceptance and updates its inventory back to “on hand.”
7. Discrepancies are stopped, annotated, reported, and resolved before release when possible.

COUNTER EXAMPLE: a return without serial reconciliation can transfer an undetected discrepancy back to the customer unit.

Severity, Checklists, and Everyday Rules

27. Security Violation Severity Guide

Failure	Likely severity
Minor admin error corrected immediately	Infraction
Missing signature, incomplete access validation, expired courier card	Infraction to violation
Improper storage in unapproved room or unattended case	Violation; possible compromise
Release to uncleared/no-need-to-know person	Compromise
Asset, hard drive, or COMSEC material cannot be located	Loss
Falsified receipt, intentional bypass, or negligent handling	Serious violation; command investigation likely

28. Practical Intake Checklist

Before accepting a SIPR asset for imaging, confirm:[12][15]

- Asset is expected and authorized.
- Courier is appointed and has required documents.
- Packaging is locked, opaque, sealed, and tamper-evident as required.
- Receipt/SF-153 matches physical asset.
- Chassis serial and media serials match.
- Receiving person is appointed and qualified.
- Storage location is approved.
- Temporary custody log is updated immediately.

DEVIATION CONSEQUENCE: each unchecked item is a potential custody, access, or storage failure.

29. Practical Return Checklist

Before releasing the asset back to the customer, confirm:[15]

- Imaging is complete.
- Asset and media serials reconcile.
- No extra media or classified notes are included.
- Customer CMCC/security point of contact was notified.
- Courier authority is valid.
- Return receipt is signed by qualified personnel.
- 3NB temporary custody log is closed.
- Customer inventory is updated.

DEVIATION CONSEQUENCE: a sloppy return can create a false record that hides loss, unauthorized access, or unresolved discrepancy.

30. Miscellaneous Rules to Live By

These rules prevent most avoidable CMCC mistakes:

1. **If you cannot prove custody, stop and reconcile.**
2. **If the marking is unclear, treat it at the higher level until corrected.**
3. **If the person is not validated, do not release the asset.**
4. **If local policy is stricter, local policy wins.**

COUNTER EXAMPLE: convenience shortcuts usually become audit findings after the fact.

Special Handling and the Bottom Line

31. Upclassing Devices to SIPR

Do not treat “this laptop is now SIPR” as an informal technician decision.

Before a chassis or hard drive is upclassed or accepted as SIPR/classified material:[16][22][28]

1. Security/CMCC authority approves the change and required storage path.
2. Supply/property chain of custody is validated from acquisition or transfer through current custodian.
3. The system or media is scanned/inspected under the approved local technical procedure before SIPR connection or imaging.
4. Chassis, drive, and removable-media serials are physically verified.
5. The device is marked for the resulting classification and caveats.
6. The SF inventory/local classified-material inventory is updated from unclassified/property-only status to classified custody status.
7. The CMCC control number is tied to the property tag, chassis serial, media serials, and chain-of-custody package.

COUNTER EXAMPLE: if the scan package or supply custody trail is missing, the command may not know what was connected to SIPR or who controlled the media before upclassification.[22]

32. SIPR Assets Are Not User-Carried IT Gear

A SIPR laptop may look like ordinary IT equipment, but once it is a SIPR/classified asset it must move as classified material—not by casual user hand-carry.[11][17]

Required movement path:

1. CMCC/security release approval.
2. SF-153 when COMSEC material is involved, or the required local classified-material hand receipt/inventory record for non-COMSEC SIPR assets.
3. Valid courier appointment or written authorization.
4. Proper packaging, continuous custody, and receipt at the destination.
5. Inventory/control-number update showing who has custody and where the asset is located.[15][17][18][22]

COUNTER EXAMPLE: “the user just moved their laptop” can become an undocumented transfer of classified material.

33. Working Notes, Drafts, and Scratch Documents

Working notes can become classified material as soon as they contain classified information.[28]

For working papers or notes:[28]

- Mark the **top and bottom** with the highest classification present.
- Date the working paper when created.
- Add portion markings when the notes will be shared, retained, or turned into a formal product.
- Use source documents or security guidance; do not invent classification decisions.

COUNTER EXAMPLE: an unmarked notebook page can still contain classified information and must be protected accordingly.

34. Maintain or Destroy Working Notes

Do not let scratch paper become an unofficial archive.[28][29]

When working notes are no longer needed:

- Destroy them using approved classified-destruction procedures.
- Record destruction when local SOP or the material type requires it.
- If retained, store and account for them at the proper classification level.
- If released outside the workspace, mark, route, and receipt them like any other classified material.[18][22]

Classified information must be destroyed only by authorized means that prevent reconstruction.[29]

COUNTER EXAMPLE: forgotten notes can create the same loss or compromise problem as a missing drive.

35. When in Doubt, Stop the Line

Pause the movement, imaging, or return when:

- Serial numbers do not match.
- Markings, caveats, or classification are unclear.
- The courier or receiver is not validated.
- Packaging, locks, seals, or storage approval are questionable.
- Notes, removable media, or labels appear unexpectedly.

Escalate to the Security Manager, CMCC custodian, COMSEC Manager, KOA Manager, or chain of command before continuing.

DEVIATION CONSEQUENCE: stopping for five minutes is cheaper than reconstructing custody after a reportable incident.

36. Bottom Line

CMCC control is about answering four questions at all times:

1. **What** classified material exists?
2. **Where** is it right now?
3. **Who** is responsible for it?
4. **What record** proves the chain of custody?

For SIPR imaging workflows, the technical task is not complete until the custody record is complete.[15][22]

DEVIATION CONSEQUENCE: if the record cannot prove custody, the command may have to treat the situation as a potential loss or compromise.

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[27]: Department of Defense, *DoDM 5200.01, Volume 3*, encl. 6, sec. 2.a. https://www.esd.whs.mil/Portals/54/Documents/DD/issuances/dodm/520001m_vol3.pdf.

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[29]: Department of Defense, *DoDM 5200.01, Volume 3*, encl. 5, destruction guidance for classified information and material. https://www.esd.whs.mil/Portals/54/Documents/DD/issuances/dodm/520001m_vol3.pdf.